

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Mandrake Black Magic

Q My system has 768 MB of RAM, a Hitachi 40 GB SATA hard disk and a Samsung DVD drive. I tried to install Mandrake Linux 10.1 which came on the *Digit* February 2005 DVD. After booting from the Installation CD 1, I get a message: "Detecting USB Devices." After this, an error pops up—"No CD-ROM device found." When I click 'OK', a notice comes up—"Please insert the Additional Drivers Floppy." I don't have any such floppy. However, all the devices work fine in Windows XP.

Sandeep Rohtak, via e-mail

A The most probable cause of your problem is that your installation CD has not been burnt properly. Burn the CD again and this time, make sure the written data is verified.

Age Of Problems

Q I am running Windows XP. I tried to install *Age of Empires 3* from a CD, but the installation stopped midway and I had to restart. Now whenever I start my computer, the Windows installer starts up and tries to install *Age of Empires 3*, and asks for CD 1. Why does this happen?

Ashmit, via e-mail

A The program launches itself when Windows boots because it's been placed in the Windows startup. The reason could be a corrupt installation CD, and this problem can be easily solved once you install the game again from the original CD (assuming you made one legal copy). If the original CD is damaged, you can probably get it replaced.

If you just want to get rid of the program being loaded at startup, run "msconfig". Go to the 'Startup' tab and look for entries that pertain to the *Age of Empires 3* setup, and uncheck those entries. The problem should not occur the next time you boot up.

F-r-a-g-m-e-n-t-e-d

Q I was using Windows XP SP2 with O&O Defragmenter 4.0 Server Edition. Now that I have uninstalled it, I am not able to use the Windows defragmenter. When I press "Defragment now" after right-clicking my hard disk icon, I get the error: "There is no defragmenter. Please

install it using Add/Remove Programs > Install/Uninstall tab". How do I restore my Windows disk defragmenter?

R Vivek, Assam

A This problem is caused because O&O Defragmenter set itself as the default Windows defragmentation tool when it was installed. After it was uninstalled, the default disk defragmenter was not re-instated. To correct this problem, open the Registry Editor and navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\MyComputer\DefragPath". In the right pane, double-click the string 'Default' and set its 'Value Data' to "%systemroot%\system32\defrag.msc %c:". The Windows defragmenter should now be restored as the default disk defragmenter tool.

Mad Monitors

Q I bought a new PC with a Samsung SyncMaster 591s 15-inch monitor. My problem with the monitor is, it starts flickering in no time; sometimes it works fine, but sometimes it starts to flicker at random. I tried changing the resolution, but it doesn't work. My PC is just two months old.

Imtiaz Khan, via e-mail

A First check if you have loaded the latest drivers for your display adapter as well as for your monitor. If the problem you're experiencing is limited to Windows, then it's likely that your monitor's refresh rate is not optimal. You can set this using 'Display Properties' in the Control Panel. Go to the 'Settings' tab and click 'Advanced'. Now click 'Monitor', set the refresh rate at anything above 70 Hz, and click 'Apply'.

If the selected refresh rate is not supported by your monitor, wait for 15 seconds, after which your earlier refresh rate will be restored. Then choose another refresh rate to see if it is supported. This way, set the highest refresh rate supported by your monitor for the resolution you're using, and the flickering should go away.

In addition to this, degauss the monitor using the controls on the monitor, and move any items that have a magnetic field (such as speakers) some distance away.

If the flickering persists and if it is not limited to Windows, then the problem is most probably that the monitor is faulty and needs to be replaced.

Hibernating Mouse

Q I have Windows XP installed. Whenever I try the hibernate or standby feature and then restart my computer, my mouse doesn't work.

Aman Jain, Rourkela, via e-mail

A Your mouse with its current drivers doesn't support the power management